In a CDCT approach, the first step is creating the contract, which happens when the HTTP request is made to the mock provider. However, in the PDCT example, the HTTP response has already been mocked out using existing testing frameworks, such as Cypress, meaning this mock response becomes the expected response within the Pact contract, as shown in figure 3.11. The contract can then be published to the broker.

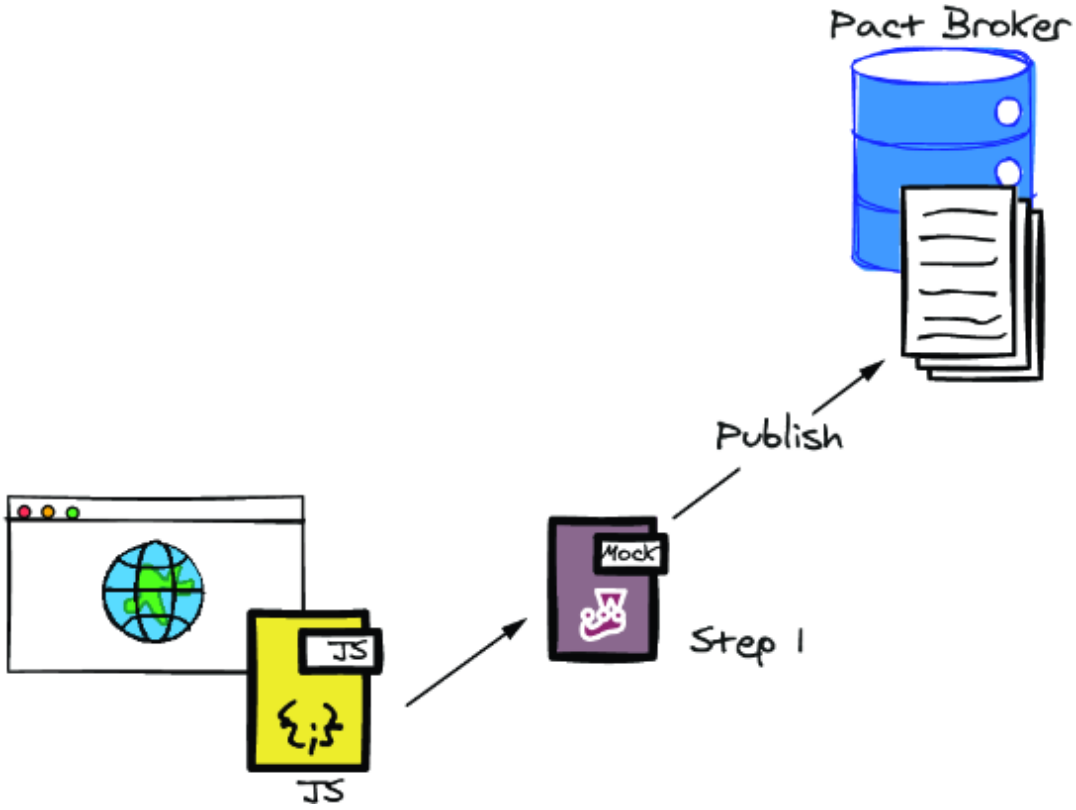


Figure 3.11 JavaScript web application, including the test mocks published contract to the pact broker

On the provider side, the Java API or event service generates its OpenAPI specification independently of the consumer web application. Then, the API tests, which capture all paths within the OpenAPI specification, run against the local running Java API or event service. The OpenAPI specification is then published to the broker, as shown in figure 3.12. One thing to note is that the PDCT or bi-directional approach is only supported by PactFlow's team plan.